

Program Accessibility for Applicants and Participants with Disabilities

Policy: Reasonable accommodations must be provided to persons with physical and/or mental disabilities.

Regulations: 7 CRF 246.7, FNS Instruction 113-1

Procedure/Additional Guidance:

Local agencies make reasonable accommodations for the known physical or mental limitations of an otherwise qualified applicant or participant with a disability. When structural changes are not viable, local agencies may achieve program accessibility through other methods. These methods include:

- Referring participants to an alternate site that is accessible and within reasonable traveling distance if a particular clinic site may not be readily accessible for disabled individuals.
- Obtaining medical data (height, weight, and hemoglobin/hematocrit) from other sources, such as a private physician, and using it as eligibility criteria (see *Certification, Eligibility and Coordination*, Section 8 of the Program Manual, Physical Presence at Certification and Recertification Visits and Certification Procedures Required Medical/Nutritional Data).
- Providing home visits by WIC staff or coordinating services with a public health nurse who can make a home visit.
- Allowing a proxy designated by the participant to pick up food benefits at the clinic site per policy.
- Offering benefits remotely to a participant per policy.